

io.netty.handler.codec.EncoderException when evaluating too many entity selectors in chat preview

[MC-251889](#) NETWORKING

Status	Resolved / Fixed
Affected	1.19 Pre-release 1
Fixed in	1.19 Pre-release 2
Reported	2022-05-18
Mojira category	Networking

REPRODUCTION TARGET

Use version:

1.19 Pre-release 1

Affected versions (1):

1.19 Pre-release 1

Environment:

Vanilla Minecraft: Java Edition dedicated server and one matching Java Edition client, both running 1.19 Pre-release 1 (launcher version ID 1.19-pre1). Run the server with Java 17 in a new, isolated server directory, use its ordinary newly generated Overworld, and keep the dedicated-server console visible for the observation agent. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Java_Edition_1.19_Pre-release_1))

PRECONDITIONS

- Use exactly Minecraft: Java Edition 1.19 Pre-release 1 for both the dedicated server and client; do not use the fixed version, 1.19 Pre-release 2.
- Use a vanilla dedicated server rather than single-player. Do not install plugins, mods, datapacks, or proxy software that could replace command parsing or chat preview handling.
- The client must be able to connect to the dedicated server. If both run on the same computer, the client can use localhost; otherwise, use the server's reachable address and configure networking as needed.
- The server must have chat preview enabled with `previews-chat=true` in `server.properties`. Chat preview was available for `/say` in this affected version. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Java_Edition_1.19?utm_source=openai))
- The reproducing player must have operator permission so that `/say` and its entity selectors can be parsed as a usable command. Grant operator status from the dedicated-server console after the player joins. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Commands/op))
- Keep the client connection view and dedicated-server console available for immediate handoff to the separate observation subsystem.
- Do not press Enter to send the reproduction command. The trigger is evaluation of the unsent command by chat preview while its text is being prepared.

STEPS TO REPRODUCE

1 VERIFIED

Create a new empty directory dedicated to this reproduction. Obtain the vanilla dedicated-server JAR for Minecraft Java Edition 1.19 Pre-release 1, place it in that directory, and rename it to server.jar for the commands below. This version is identified as 1.19-pre1 by the launcher and requires Java 17. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Java_Edition_1.19_Pre-release_1))

SUCCESS CUE The isolated directory contains the 1.19 Pre-release 1 server file named server.jar.

2 INFERRED

Open a terminal or command prompt in the server directory and perform the server's initial launch. Do not enter this command in Minecraft chat.

INPUT `java -jar server.jar nogui`

SUCCESS CUE The server creates its initial configuration files, including eula.txt, and reports that the EULA must be accepted before normal startup.

3 INFERRED

After the initial server process has stopped, open eula.txt in a plain-text editor and change its EULA setting to true. Save the file without changing its filename.

INPUT `eula=true`

SUCCESS CUE The saved eula.txt file contains eula=true.

4 VERIFIED

Open server.properties in a plain-text editor. Find the previews-chat property and set it to true. If the property is absent, add the exact line as a new property. Save the file. Chat preview for commands such as /say is part of the affected version's behavior. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Java_Edition_1.19?utm_source=openai))

INPUT `previews-chat=true`

SUCCESS CUE The saved server.properties file contains exactly one active previews-chat=true setting.

5 INFERRED

Start the dedicated server again from its directory. Leave this terminal open throughout reproduction so the observation agent can inspect server output.

INPUT `java -jar server.jar nogui`

SUCCESS CUE The console reports that server startup is complete and presents a usable server-console input prompt; the ordinary server world has been generated or loaded.

6 VERIFIED

In the Minecraft Launcher, create or select an installation for 1.19-pre1, use a separate game directory if available, and launch it. On the main menu, confirm the displayed client version is 1.19 Pre-release 1 rather than 1.19 Pre-release 2 or a release version. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Java_Edition_1.19_Pre-release_1))

SUCCESS CUE The Minecraft client is at the main menu and identifies itself as 1.19 Pre-release 1.

7 VERIFIED

Before joining, navigate from the main menu to Options, then Chat Settings. Set the Chat Preview option to ON if it is disabled, then return to the main menu. This client option existed because chat preview could be globally disabled by the client. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Java_Edition_1.19?utm_source=openai))

SUCCESS CUE The client-side Chat Preview setting is ON.

8 REPORT

Select Multiplayer, use Direct Connection or add the server, enter its address, and join. Use localhost when the client and server are running on the same computer; otherwise use the actual server address. Acknowledge or continue past any chat-preview warning shown while connecting.

INPUT localhost

SUCCESS CUE The player is present in the dedicated server's generated Overworld, surrounding terrain has rendered, and movement responds normally.

9 VERIFIED

In the dedicated-server console, grant operator status to the connected player. Replace <player_name> with the player's exact Java account name. Because this is the server console, enter the command without a leading slash. ([minecraft.wiki](https://minecraft.wiki/w/Commands/op))

INPUT op <player_name>

SUCCESS CUE The server console confirms that the named player was made a server operator, or otherwise confirms that the player is already an operator.

10 REPORT

Return focus to the connected client. Wait until the nearby chunks are fully rendered and player controls respond normally. Remain in the ordinary Overworld and do not remove naturally loaded entities.

SUCCESS CUE The player remains connected in the normal generated world, terrain is loaded, and the server console remains accessible for monitoring.

11 INFERRED

Verify that command chat preview is active before using the oversized selector input. Press T, type the harmless unsent test command exactly as shown, and do not press Enter. Wait for the preview area above the chat input to respond.

INPUT /say preview_check

SUCCESS CUE The command is accepted as valid input and a server-controlled preview is shown or updated above the chat edit box.

12 INFERRED

Clear the harmless test without sending it. With the chat field focused, press Ctrl+A to select all text and then press Backspace. Keep the chat screen open.

SUCCESS CUE The chat input field is empty, chat remains open, and no command has been sent.

13 **INFERRED**

Prepare the high-selector command in the operating-system clipboard so it can be inserted in one input action. Generate exactly the four characters /say followed by exactly 80 repetitions of a space and @e. The resulting text must be 244 characters long, contain 80 @e selectors, have one space before every selector, and contain no line break.

INPUT `"/say" + (" @e" repeated exactly 80 times)`

SUCCESS CUE The clipboard contains a single 244-character line beginning with /say @e and containing exactly 80 occurrences of @e.

14 **INFERRED** **TRIGGER**

With the empty chat field still focused, press Ctrl+V once to paste the complete 244-character command. Do not press Enter, do not close chat, and do not interact with any screen that appears after the paste. Pasting is used to make the large selector-bearing text change a single deterministic chat-preview request.

INPUT `"/say" + (" @e" repeated exactly 80 times); paste with Ctrl+V and do not press Enter`

SUCCESS CUE The paste action has been issued while chat preview is enabled; no command-send action has been performed.

HANDOFF TO OBSERVATION

The 244-character unsent /say command containing 80 @e selectors has just been inserted into the chat input while server and client chat preview are enabled. Enter has not been pressed, the client must receive no further input, and the dedicated-server console remains visible. Begin observing the client connection state and server output immediately.

UNCERTAINTIES

- The report does not specify an exact selector count at which the oversized preview occurs. It gives ten selectors as an example and states that continuing to add @e eventually reaches the trigger. The plan uses 80 selectors as a deterministic high-count input while retaining the reported /say and @e syntax.
- The amount of preview data generated by each @e depends on the entities currently loaded in the ordinary server world. The report provides no seed, coordinates, entity count, or explicit entity-spawning setup, so the plan preserves its stated normal-world condition rather than inventing a custom population.
- Pasting the full selector sequence in one action is a practical execution choice intended to produce one clearly bounded trigger and immediate observation handoff. The report describes continuing to type @e but does not explicitly discuss clipboard input.
- The report does not specify an operating system, server memory allocation, world seed, game mode, coordinates, or a requirement for multiple players. The plan therefore uses one operator player, the server's default world settings, and no special seed or coordinates.
- The external sources were used only to verify version-sensitive operational details: the launcher identifier 1.19-pre1, Java 17, the previews-chat server property, command chat preview availability, the client Chat Preview option, and dedicated-server operator handling.

MANUAL RESULT

Version used	
Reproduced?	YES / NO / PARTIAL
Trigger reached?	YES / NO
Crash file	
Notes	
Tested by / date	